PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Detection and Threat Engineer | Cyber Security Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience in detection engineering, threat hunting, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform ownership. I have led the design and deployment of high-fidelity detection rules across endpoint, identity, cloud and Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) environments for an organisation of 8,000 users, leveraging CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR). I combine hands-on detection engineering with proactive threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and I have built Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate alert triage and reduce mean time to respond. I am experienced in owning threat detection capability end-to-end, from rule development and tuning through to incident response and post-incident review, and I am eager to bring this expertise to a high-growth payment technology environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language), CrowdStrike Query Language (CQL), MITRE ATT&CK, detection rule development and tuning
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), SentinelOne awareness
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Azure cloud security
- **SaaS and Email Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft 365 Defender, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, SOAR automation, Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR playbook development
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Own and drive threat detection engineering in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, authoring and continuously tuning high-fidelity detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) to minimise false positives across endpoint, identity, cloud and SaaS environments.
- Lead proactive threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), investigating behavioural anomalies and attacker indicators of compromise (IOCs) across the 8,000-user estate.
- Engineer and maintain SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage and containment workflows, reducing analyst workload and improving mean time to respond (MTTR) significantly.
- Manage the full security incident response lifecycle in line with NIST 800-61, leading triage, containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review for critical and high-severity incidents.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Discover and Falcon Spotlight across the enterprise estate, ensuring full visibility and continuous endpoint health monitoring.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, maintaining detection coverage across cloud-hosted and on-premises workloads.
- Configure and govern Azure Active Directory (Microsoft Entra ID) including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement and SSO integrations, hardening identity and access management (IAM) posture.

- Oversee BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) deployment, enforcing least-privilege access and just-in-time (JIT) provisioning for privileged accounts.
- Conduct continuous vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS and AppCheck, prioritising findings by risk and tracking remediation through to closure.
- Collaborate with infrastructure and application teams to embed security controls into cloud-hosted services and SaaS platforms, including Mimecast and Intune MDM/MAM.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst

- Performed tier-2 and tier-3 alert triage and threat investigation within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, escalating confirmed incidents and supporting threat hunting campaigns.
- Developed KQL detection rules and analytical workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, improving visibility of lateral movement, credential abuse and malware activity across the organisation.
- Supported phased deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to 8,000 endpoints, including onboarding, policy configuration and exclusion management.
- Managed Azure Active Directory identity governance including Conditional Access policy rollout, MFA deployment and SSO configuration for cloud and hybrid applications.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-rated reports and tracking remediation activity with infrastructure teams.
- Contributed to incident response operations aligned to NIST 800-61, assisting in containment and eradication of security incidents including phishing, malware and insider threat events.
- Administered Tanium endpoint management platform, supporting software patching and compliance monitoring across Windows server and desktop estate.
- Configured Intune MDM and MAM policies for Windows, iOS and Android devices, ensuring corporate data protection on managed and bring-your-own-device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Managed Check Point Harmony firewall policies and Mimecast email security platform, maintaining perimeter defences and anti-phishing controls.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security, quality and infrastructure engineering for a SaaS and FinTech supplier management platform, supporting cloud-hosted and on-premises environments.
- Configured and managed network security controls including firewall rules, virtual private network (VPN) and network access control, reducing the organisation's external attack surface.
- Applied CIS Controls security hardening across server and endpoint infrastructure, improving baseline security posture.
- Administered Microsoft 365 including Azure Active Directory, Exchange Online, Teams and SharePoint, managing user lifecycle, permissions and security configurations.
- Performed vulnerability identification and remediation tracking, working with development and operations teams to close security gaps in the SaaS platform.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline routine infrastructure and security operations tasks, reducing manual effort.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and deployed a comprehensive detection engineering library in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, covering credential theft, lateral movement, privilege escalation and data exfiltration scenarios across endpoint, identity and cloud.
- Led threat hunting programme identifying previously undetected attacker activity in cloud and SaaS environments, enabling proactive containment before escalation to critical incidents.
- Built SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that automated over 60% of high-volume low-fidelity alert triage, freeing analyst capacity for complex threat investigations.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon suite at scale across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint visibility within six months of deployment.

- Obtained Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification while delivering senior security operations responsibilities full-time.
- Deployed and operationalised Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate detection coverage and security controls against real-world attack scenarios.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)